

Portland Funnel. Triggers and Effects Map.

The skeleton. Every element, every trigger mechanism, every mental step, every threshold movement, in the order Sarah's experiencing them.

How to read this doc. Every element's broken into four pieces. The *element* itself is what she physically encounters. The *trigger mechanism* is why the element does what it does. The *mental step / effect* is the thing that's happening in her head. The *threshold movement* is how desire, certainty, or trust are shifting as a result.

Mental step and effect are one thing. The step she's taking inside her head is the effect the trigger produced in her. Don't split them.

This is the output of Pass 2 of the reverse-engineering process. Pass 1 was a surface inventory. Every element of the funnel, listed in the order she experiences them, no analysis. Pass 2 is this doc. It's the meaning behind every element. You do them in that order on purpose. If you're analyzing while you inventory, you'll miss elements and you'll invent effects to fit your theory.

You aren't going to write Portland's copy. You're going to fill Portland's **proven structure** with Linda's research language. The structure is what you're mining here.

THE AD

ELEMENT 01 • AD IMAGE

A quiet shot of one woman alone

Still photograph. One woman, mid-40s, sitting on a mat in soft morning light. There's no studio branding in frame. No text overlay. No other people.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"Stop scrolling."

A half-second pause. That's the whole mental event.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Pattern Interrupt Visual

Her feed is loud. It's full of products, faces, claims. This image is quiet. It's breaking the visual rhythm by refusing to compete on the feed's terms.

THRESHOLD

None yet

Attention's bought. The image isn't doing threshold work. It's buying the shot at doing threshold work.

ELEMENT 02 • AD COPY • PAIN LINE

Names a feeling she's lived with but never seen written down

One-line hook that opens the ad copy. It articulates the specific texture of her current state. The quiet version of "I used to feel like myself and now I don't," in language she's thought but never said out loud.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

"This is about me."

The suppressed want surfaces. She moves from "I'm scrolling" to "this is for me."

Headline Naming Her Exact Pain

The sentence describes an internal state she assumed was hers alone. Seeing it named by someone else is the mechanism.

THRESHOLD

Desire ↑

It's the first real threshold movement. Desire lifts because the want was already there. The ad just made it speakable.

ELEMENT 03 • AD COPY • TEASE

Hints at a way out. Signals real Portland women are using it.

Second beat of the ad copy. It doesn't name the solution. It doesn't say "pilates." It says there's a way out, and that women in the Portland area are already using it to snap out of the cycle.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"Wait. What are they doing?"

A loop opens. She wants the answer.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Implicit Solution Tease + Local Proof

Two mechanisms stacked. The path exists but isn't named (curiosity loop). Real women near her are using it (local social proof, not generic).

THRESHOLD

Certainty ↑

Desire held

*First nudge on certainty.
Someone's telling her a path
exists. Desire stays alive
instead of collapsing back.*

ELEMENT 04 • AD CTA

"Tap if this sounds familiar"

The button. It isn't "Book a class." It isn't "Learn more." The button continues the conversation the copy started and it resolves the curiosity loop on her terms.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"I'm willing to keep going."

The tap feels like nodding along. It isn't committing.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Low-Threshold Agreement CTA

The language frames the click as an act of identification, not commitment. She's agreeing with the copy, not agreeing to a purchase.

THRESHOLD

Trust neutral

Certainty neutral

Neither's tested. The CTA's an invitation, not a demand. It isn't trying to close. It's trying to earn the click.

Checkpoint. End of the ad. Desire's lifted. Certainty's got its first nudge. Trust hasn't been asked for anything. She's clicked through not because she decided to buy. She clicked because she agreed she's the person the ad described.

THE LANDING PAGE

ELEMENT 05 • LP HEADLINE

"Where women come back to themselves"

The first thing she sees on the page. Hero-sized. It's identity framing, not service framing. There's no mention of pilates. No mention of classes.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"This is the place that matches the feeling."

*She's staying on the page.
Keep reading.*

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

**Promise Continuity
Headline**

The headline picks up the promise the ad made and gives it a name. The page isn't restarting her. It's continuing her.

THRESHOLD

Certainty ↑

Desire held

The page has earned the next thirty seconds of her attention.

ELEMENT 06 • FAILED-ATTEMPTS LIST

The page shows it knows what she's already tried

A short section listing the things she's already tried and quit. The apps. The memberships. The resolutions. The cleanses. The YouTube routines. It's non-judgmental. There's no "here's why those are bad." Just: we know these are the things.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

"They understand the pattern, not just the pain."

Defenses drop.

Pattern Recognition Before Prescription

The page demonstrates it understands her history before it suggests anything new.

THRESHOLD

Certainty ↑

She's got something to lose by assuming this is another failed attempt. The page just earned the right to be heard out.

ELEMENT 07 • WHY-THIS-IS-DIFFERENT SECTION

The mechanism. The fulcrum of the page.

A longer block that explains why this studio won't turn out like the others. Past attempts demanded she become a different person starting tomorrow, with no off-ramp. That all-or-nothing structure is what guaranteed each quit. This place is built around small low-risk steps that compound. One hour. See how it feels. No commitment to the next thing.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"There's an actual reason this could work."

The cycle's named and reframed. The path forward doesn't require willpower she doesn't have.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Mechanism Reframe

The section names the cycle itself. Not the behavior. The structure that produced the behavior. Then it offers a different structure.

THRESHOLD

Certainty ↑↑

It's the page's biggest certainty lift.

Everything before this is setup. Everything after is payoff. This is the fulcrum.

ELEMENT 08 • RACHEL'S STORY

Identity-matched testimonial that opens with the doubt

A single testimonial from Rachel, a 43-year-old mom of two who lives 15 minutes from the studio. It opens with her skepticism. "I'd already quit three gyms." It doesn't open with her result. The middle describes the mechanism in action. One class, no pressure, came back. The end is a quiet arrival. It isn't a transformation claim.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"I see someone like me who did this."

She's imagining herself in the room.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Doubt-First Identity Match

The story opens where Sarah is right now. Then it shows Rachel clear the exact objection Sarah's about to have.

THRESHOLD

Certainty ↑

Trust ↑

Trust starts to form because

Rachel's doubt matches Sarah's doubt.

ELEMENT 09 • WALK-IN DESCRIPTION

Removes every unknown before she has to ask

A short paragraph that walks her through the first visit in order. The instructor knows her name when she arrives. No one's looking at her form. She'll leave knowing whether this is for her or not.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"I know what to expect when I get there."

Anxiety drops.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Pre-Emptive Unknown Removal

The page answers the questions she would've asked if she were brave enough to ask them. Before she asks them.

THRESHOLD

Certainty crosses

It's happening before the CTA. The page is doing the heavy lifting on certainty so the click's easy.

ELEMENT 10 • CTA BLOCK

Free. Zero commitment. Framed as discovery.

The page's primary CTA. The offer is one free class, consistent with the low-risk mechanism the page already promised in element 7. It's framed as discovery, not purchase. There's no upsell visible. No email capture behind a second wall.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"This is something I could actually do."

The cost-benefit math collapses to zero.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Zero-Commitment Entry Offer

One obvious path. No competing asks. By this point the cost's been driven to zero and the unknowns are gone.

THRESHOLD

Trust holds

Certainty holds

Certainty doesn't need to be perfect because the action's small and the unknowns were already removed upstream. She books.

THE IN-STUDIO EXPERIENCE

ELEMENT 11 • IN-STUDIO GREETING

The ad and page, delivered by a real person

She walks in the door. The instructor greets her by name. The energy of the room matches the tone of the page. Nothing's louder than it was online. Nothing's quieter either.

MENTAL STEP / EFFECT

What's happening in her head

"This is exactly what they promised."

Every threshold gets its final test passed in her body.

TRIGGER

The element that's causing it

Promise-to-Reality Continuity

The experience she was sold is the experience she's receiving. There's no ad-to-product gap.

THRESHOLD

Desire above

Certainty above

Trust above

The sale's alive. All three are crossing before she ever pays for the second class.

THE CHAIN AT A GLANCE

#	MENTAL STEP (Q4)	TRIGGER (Q5)	THRESHOLD
01	"Stop scrolling." <i>A pause in the feed.</i>	Pattern Interrupt Visual <i>Quiet image in a loud feed.</i>	Attention
02	"This is about me." <i>Recognition. She's seen.</i>	Headline Naming Her Pain <i>Language pulled from customer research.</i>	Desire ↑
03	"What are they doing?" <i>A curiosity loop opens.</i>	Tease + Local Proof <i>Path exists. Women near her are using it.</i>	Certainty ↑
04	"I'm willing to keep going." <i>Nodding along. Not committing.</i>	Low-Threshold Agreement CTA <i>"Tap if this sounds familiar."</i>	Neutral
05	"This matches the feeling." <i>Keep reading.</i>	Promise Continuity Headline <i>"Where women come back to themselves."</i>	Certainty ↑
06	"They understand the pattern." <i>Defenses drop.</i>	Failed-Attempts List <i>Recognition before prescription.</i>	Certainty ↑
07	"There's an actual reason this could work." <i>Cycle named and reframed.</i>	Mechanism Reframe <i>Small low-risk steps, not all-or-nothing.</i>	Certainty ↑↑
08	"Someone like me did this."	Doubt-First Testimonial	Trust ↑

	<i>She's in the room.</i>	<i>Rachel. Skepticism first, result second.</i>	
09	"I know what to expect." <i>Anxiety drops.</i>	Pre-Emptive Unknown Removal <i>What the first visit actually looks like.</i>	Crosses
10	"I could actually do this." <i>Cost-benefit collapses.</i>	Zero-Commitment Entry Offer <i>One free class. One button. One path.</i>	Holds
11	"Exactly what they promised." <i>Body confirms the page.</i>	Promise-to-Reality Continuity <i>Real person. Real room. No gap.</i>	All three

Eleven elements. Eleven mental steps. Three thresholds crossed by the time she walks out of her first class. This is the skeleton. Your job isn't to copy their language. It's to fill this structure with Linda's.